

DanScribe AI

Professional Edition

User Guide — Version 2.0

March 2026 | Windows 10/11 | Powered by OpenAI Whisper + Anthropic Claude

1. Introduction

DanScribe AI converts audio recordings into accurate text using OpenAI's Whisper AI engine. It supports all 11 official South African languages and can transcribe audio in its original language or translate it directly into English. Version 2.0 adds speaker identification and AI-powered meeting summaries via Anthropic Claude.

2. Getting Started

2.1 System Requirements

Requirement	Details
Operating System	Windows 10 or later (64-bit)
RAM	4 GB minimum — 8 GB recommended for Medium model
Disk Space	150 MB (Base) to 1.5 GB (Medium)
Internet	Required on first run to download the AI model

2.2 Launching the Application

Double-click **DanScribe_v2.exe** to open the application. No installation is required.

■ On first launch, Windows may show a security warning. Click 'More info' then 'Run anyway'.

3. Interface Overview

Element	Description
Logo + SA Flag	DanScribe AI branding with South African flag
■■ Settings	Open Settings to enter your Claude API key
1. Select Task	Choose Original Language or Translate to English
2. Audio Language	Select the language spoken in the audio
3. AI Model	Choose Whisper model size (speed vs accuracy)

Element	Description
4. Speaker ID	Enable speaker identification + set expected number
Status Label	Shows current processing status
Progress Bar	Visual progress indicator
■ START PROCESSING	Main button — opens file picker and begins transcription
■ Assign Speaker Names	Replace Speaker 1/2/3 labels with real names
■ Summarize with Claude	Generate AI meeting summary (requires API key)
Output Box	Preview of transcript or summary

4. How to Transcribe an Audio File

1. Select your **Task** — Original Language or Translate to English.
2. Select the **Audio Language** — choose the language spoken in the recording, or leave on Auto-Detect.
3. Select your **AI Model** — see Section 5 for guidance.
4. If the recording has multiple speakers, enable **Speaker Identification** and set the expected number of speakers.
5. Click **■ START PROCESSING** and browse to your audio file.
6. Wait for the progress bar to complete.
7. A success message appears. Your files are saved to **Downloads\DanScribe_Transcriptions**

✓ Output is saved as both .txt and .docx files automatically.

5. AI Model Selection

Model	Speed	Accuracy	Best For
Base (Fast - 74MB)	Fast	Good	Quick drafts, clear English audio
Small (Accurate - 244MB)	Moderate	Very Good	Everyday use, most SA languages
Medium (Professional - 769MB)	Slow	Excellent	Afrikaans, Zulu, Xhosa, Sesotho — RECOMMENDED

■ Afrikaans users: The Medium model is strongly recommended. Smaller models may incorrectly transcribe Afrikaans as Dutch.

5.1 Downloading the Medium Model on a Slow Connection

The Medium model is 769 MB. On slow connections, use wget to resume interrupted downloads.

Step 1 — Install wget:

```
winget install wget
```

Step 2 — Download with resume support (run in Command Prompt, not PowerShell):

```
wget --continue -O "C:\Users\YourName\.cache\whisper\medium.pt" "https://openaipublic.azureedge.net/main/whisper/models/345ae4da62f9b3d59415adc60127b97c714f32e89e936602e85993674d08dcb1/medium.pt"
```

■ Replace 'YourName' with your actual Windows username. The --continue flag resumes if interrupted.

6. Speaker Identification

Speaker Identification automatically detects when different people are speaking and labels each section as Speaker 1, Speaker 2, etc.

6.1 How to Use

1. Enable the **Identify different speakers** switch.
2. Set the **Expected speakers** dropdown to the number of people in the recording.
3. Click ■ **START PROCESSING** and select your file.
4. After transcription, click ■ **Assign Speaker Names**.
5. Type a name next to each Speaker label, then click **Confirm & Continue**.

✓ Speaker detection uses pause analysis. For best results, set the correct number of expected speakers before processing. Clear pauses between turns improve accuracy.

6.2 Current Limitations

Speaker identification in v2.0 is based on detecting pauses between speech segments. It works well in formal meetings where speakers take clear turns. However, it has limitations:

- Rapid back-and-forth conversation may result in more speaker labels than expected.
- Overlapping speech or interruptions are not handled.
- The feature cannot yet recognise *who* is speaking — only *that* a change has occurred.
- Improved speaker recognition using voice fingerprinting is planned for a future version.

■ If speaker labels are incorrect, you can still use the transcript as-is and pass it to the AI Summary — Claude will produce a useful summary even without perfect speaker separation.

7. AI Meeting Summary

The AI Summary feature uses Anthropic Claude to generate a professional meeting summary from the transcript, including main points, decisions, and action items.

7.1 Setup (one time only)

1. Click ■■ **Settings** (top-right of the main window).
2. Click the blue link to open console.anthropic.com and register for a free account.
3. Create an API key and copy it.
4. Paste the key into the API Key field and click **Save Settings**.

7.2 Generating a Summary

1. Complete a transcription (and optionally assign speaker names).
2. Click **Summarize with Claude**.
3. The summary appears in the output box and is saved to the output folder.

✓ The summary is written in the same language as the transcript. Assigning real speaker names before summarising produces more useful minutes (e.g. 'Johan suggested...' instead of 'Speaker 1 suggested...').

■ Claude API usage costs approximately R0.50 per summary. Each user uses their own API key — your key is stored locally on your device only.

7.3 Understanding API Costs

Using the AI Summary feature requires a Claude API key from Anthropic. This is a pay-as-you-use service — there is no monthly subscription.

Usage	Approximate Cost (ZAR)
1 meeting summary (short, ~30 min recording)	R0.30 – R0.60
1 meeting summary (long, ~2 hour recording)	R0.80 – R1.50
20 summaries per month	R6 – R20
50 summaries per month	R15 – R50

✓ Anthropic provides new accounts with free credits to get started. For most users, the monthly cost will be less than R20. You can monitor your exact usage at console.anthropic.com.

8. Language Selection

Setting	Language
Auto-Detect	Let Whisper identify the language (less reliable for Afrikaans)
af — Afrikaans	Always select for Afrikaans audio
en — English	English audio
st — Sesotho	
zu — isiZulu	
xh — isiXhosa	
tn — Setswana	
nso — Sepedi	
ss — Siswati	
ve — Tshivenda	
ts — Xitsonga	

Setting	Language
nr — isiNdebele	

■ Always select 'af' for Afrikaans audio and use the Medium model. Auto-Detect may identify Afrikaans as Dutch.

8.1 A Note on Transcription Accuracy for Non-English Languages

DanScribe AI uses OpenAI Whisper, which was trained primarily on English data. While it supports all 11 official South African languages, the following applies to ALL non-English audio:

- Transcription accuracy is good but not perfect — spelling errors and word substitutions will occur in any non-English language.
- The Medium model produces the best results; smaller models are significantly less accurate for South African languages.
- Uncommon words, names, and technical terms are more likely to be transcribed incorrectly.
- Languages with less internet training data (e.g. Tshivenda, Siswati) will have lower accuracy than more widely spoken languages.

■ **RECOMMENDATION:** For all non-English audio, it is strongly recommended to use 'Translate to English' rather than 'Original Language'. English output is significantly more accurate and easier to review. The AI Summary can then be generated in English, which also produces better results. If a summary in the original language is required, you can ask Claude to translate it afterwards.

■ Always treat the transcript as a working draft. Read through it before generating a summary or sharing it. The AI Summary (Section 7) will correct most errors automatically.

9. Output Files

All output is saved automatically to:

C:\Users\YourName\Downloads\DanScribe_Transcriptions\

File	Description
filename_transcript_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.txt	Plain text transcript
filename_transcript_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.docx	Formatted Word document transcript
summary_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.txt	Plain text AI summary
summary_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.docx	Formatted Word document summary

10. Tips for Best Results

- Use clear, high-quality recordings with minimal background noise.
- For non-English audio, use 'Translate to English' for best accuracy — see Section 8.1.
- Always use the Medium model for South African languages.
- Treat every transcript as a working draft — review it before sharing.
- Set the correct number of expected speakers before processing.

- Assign speaker names before generating the AI summary for best minutes.
- Long files (30+ minutes) may take several minutes — this is normal.
- First use of each model requires internet to download the model file.
- If in doubt, generate the AI Summary — it corrects most transcription errors automatically.

11. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Afrikaans transcribed as Dutch	Set language to 'af' and use the Medium model
Medium model download keeps failing	Use wget with --continue flag — see Section 5.1
App is very slow	Switch to Base or Small model
Too many speakers identified	Set 'Expected speakers' to the correct number
Speaker names not saving	Click 'Confirm & Continue' in the Name Assignment window
Summarize button stays disabled	Complete a transcription first
API key error	Check your key in  Settings — ensure no spaces
Audio file not supported	Convert to .mp3 or .wav using Audacity or VLC